

LISTEX SKI TV - DAN KEELEY INTERVIEW - SNOW-CAMP.ORG.UK

Ski TV are here at the Snow Centre at LISTX International Trade Exchange and my guest is Dan Keeley from Snow Camp and Dan, welcome. Welcome back to LISTX. It's great to be here.

It feels strange in many ways that, you know, it feels like not much has changed because we're all back together again. But of course, you know, at the same time it's been, yeah, turbulent 18 months for all of us. But no, it's great to be back and good to see you again.

Thank you very much. And can you tell our ski TV viewers a bit about Snow Camp and the updates, what's been happening over the past year? I believe that in the lockdown a ton of things have been happening anyway. Yeah, it's been amazing, actually, in so many ways.

You know, it's been such a challenging time for the whole industry. But for Snow Camp, for those that don't know what we do, we change the lives of underprivileged inner-city young people with the power of skiing and snowboarding. So we're all about broadening horizons, raising aspirations and developing life skills, qualifications and job opportunities in the industry as well.

We've been going for almost 18 years now. We've just stayed in our lane and we love what we do. But certainly over the past 18 months, the young people are coming to us saying, you know, we're actually struggling with our mental wellbeing as well as all the snow sports training that you're helping us with, you know, and all the confidence building and everything else.

So, you know, we noticed that their mental wellbeing was actually a barrier to their success. So we added on a brand new stop, breathe, think mental health service for the young people, which is now a fully fledged program. And we're pretty proud to say that we've supported a thousand young people live at the Snow Censors across the UK this summer.

And that's the first stage on their 12-month journey with us. So, yeah, very, very challenging times. But, you know, it's just great to be here now.

I'm Laquan. I'm from London. And this is my story.

My life was going backwards, united. We grew up in a place, the same old dramas, same old faces, same old routine. You don't choose it.

It chooses you. You're on the wrong side of the fence, looking in. And life just passes you back.

But I wanted more. Trust me, it wasn't for Laquan trying. Every time I gave him my best shot, my opportunities just seemed to vanish into thin air.

I wasn't expecting anything that day in the youth club. But there it was, something different. A chance to change direction.

And I took it. It wasn't easy. It had ups and downs.

But suddenly I could see a new path. And I was the one in control. Did I expect to get a new career and qualifications? No way.

But you know what? When you're motivated, determined, someone gives you a chance, life just goes in the right direction. I'm Laquan. I'm from London.

And Snow Camp was my Switch 180 no more. Young people need the opportunity Snow Camp provides. And with your support, many more young lives can be turned around.

If you can, please support the campaign. And Ski TV is very, very proud to be a Snow Camp sponsor. We run all of your content on the channel.

And in the future we want to get more involved in supporting programs and that sort of thing. And I know that these kids, a lot of them are into video production these days. And it's something that we can offer them to do with Ski TV to become interns, I suppose, to produce their own content.

It could be something really great. Totally. And I think a few years ago we had Jake here who was helping you out behind the scenes.

So we absolutely love that. And of course we've got the National Snow Show coming up where no doubt some of our young people want to get involved. But as a charity, I think those that really know and love what we do have always known that we're not in the business of developing the next wave of skiing structures necessarily.

We want to set young people up to go on to any other positive destination in life. So if that's Ski TV TV production, then good for them. That's what we're all about.

So if we can take a young person out of the heavy inner city environment, perhaps they're caught up in gang culture or knife crime and what have you, if we can take them on that three-stage journey and raise their aspirations at the end of that and set them up to go on to any other career that they wish to go on to, then we're pretty proud of that as a charity. Perfect. And just give us a little bit of a pricey on how Snow Camp's got going and where it's going in the future.

Yeah, well, all credit to Dan Charlish, our founder. I think it was 18 years ago now where he was working with a group of underprivileged inner city young people, and there was no opportunity for them to experience the mountain environment. It just didn't exist.

So, you know, the entrepreneur that he is, he's secured some funding, you know, took this group of 13 young people out to the mountain. And then I think the year after, he was getting on for, you know, 150, if I remember the photo in our office. So since then, it's just been this remarkable journey and we've got, you know, a really dedicated team and, you know, full credit to our program managers who actually do the work with the young people.

You know, they're multifaceted because they've got their passion for skiing and snowboarding, you know, to have the relationship with the young people and to meet them where they are, given the challenges that they face is, you know, it's just remarkable what they do day to day. So, yeah, really looking forward to this winter season and, you know, hopefully we can have that big group shot of as many young people back out there this winter as well. Yeah, terrific.

How can people find out more about Snow Camp online? Yeah, just Google Snow Camp, the charity, and you can find us pretty much on any social media channel at Snow Camp Charity. Yeah, you'll find us pretty quickly in our website. It's pretty easy to navigate, we think.

So, yeah, get in touch, you know, the more people that are passionate about snow sports and, you know, changing lives with young people, then we want to hear from them. And, of course, people can donate money to Snow Camp, they can donate resources, they can donate services. You're open for all of that sort of thing.

Yeah, absolutely. I think all the support we're lucky enough to receive comes down to fundraising and sponsorship or added value. You know, for example, you know, being at the snow show is going to be amazing for us.

So just that profile is fantastic. The same with List X, you know, giving us a presence here is, you know, we're hugely grateful for that. But, you know, whether you're an organization or an individual, then, you know, we'd love to hear from you.

Dan Keeley, Snow Camp, thank you for being with us on Ski TV once again. Thank you for all the great work you do for the youth of Great Britain and the world. Thank you.